

Appendix B — Complete question-type index

What this is for. You are in a practice paper and something unfamiliar has appeared. Find it in the left-hand column, go to the section named on the right, read that section and nothing else. Every entry points at the place where the type is taught with its own trap list and its own band-6 mistake.

A word on the counts before you use them. The official type counts and this book's counts differ in two places, and neither is a disagreement:

- **Listening:** ielts.org's format page names **six** types. This book works through **eleven layouts**, because the completion family splits into five printed layouts that behave differently on screen, and multiple choice splits into its one-answer and multiple-answer forms — a *choose TWO* item occupies two question numbers and is worth two marks. $5 + 2 + 4 = 11$. [src: ielts.org — IELTS Academic: Listening test format]
- **Reading:** ielts.org's format page defines **11** numbered task types; the 2023 sample-tasks PDF names **14** by splitting the completion formats apart. Both are official. **This book uses the 11**, because Cambridge files its own teaching material under that numbering. [src: ielts.org — Reading test format; ielts.org — Academic Reading Sample Tasks 2023 PDF, p.1]

One thing you cannot budget for: ielts.org answers "*How many questions are there?*" with **"Variable"** for all eleven Reading types [src: ielts.org — Reading test format].

B.1 — Listening: the eleven layouts

40 questions · 4 parts of 10 · one mark each · played **once** · answers come in order for **every** type.

#	Layout	Official parent type	Taught in
1	Form completion	Completion family	Ch 2 §1. Form completion
2	Note completion	Completion family	Ch 2 §2. Note completion
3	Table completion	Completion family	Ch 2 §3. Table completion
4	Flow-chart completion	Completion family	Ch 2 §4. Flow-chart completion
5	Summary completion	Completion family	Ch 2 §5. Summary completion
6	Sentence completion	Sentence completion	Ch 2 §6. Sentence completion
7	Multiple choice — single answer	Multiple choice	Ch 2 §7. Multiple choice — single answer
8	Multiple choice — multiple answer (<i>choose TWO</i>)	Multiple choice	Ch 2 §8. Multiple choice — multiple answer
9	Matching	Matching	Ch 2 §9. Matching
10	Plan / map / diagram labelling	Plan, map or diagram labelling	Ch 2 §10. Plan / map / diagram labelling
11	Short-answer questions	Short-answer questions	Ch 2 §11. Short-answer questions

Expect short-answer questions even though one official document omits them. The 2023 Listening sample-tasks preamble lists only five types and then ships a short-answer task and its key later in the same PDF. The format page's six is the authoritative count. [src: ielts.org — Listening sample tasks 2023, p.1 vs pp. 11-13]

Cross-cutting Listening references:

You need	Go to
The marking rules — word limits, hyphens, articles, spelling, capitalisation, two answers in one gap	Ch 2 §Answer-rule reference
The correction traps, in both directions	Ch 2 §Tips & tricks , tip 4
The mark budget — what each band costs in marks	Ch 2 §Band descriptor decoder
Where to get audio, and the five accents	Ch 2 §Where the audio comes from
The computer timing that has no transfer window	Ch 2 § The timing that changes everything
The L1 traps that turn a heard answer into a zero	Ch 2 §L1 alert

B.2 — Academic Reading: the eleven task types

3 passages · 40 questions · 60 minutes **including** transfer · one mark each · no negative marking.

#	Task type	In passage order?	Taught in
1	Multiple choice (both forms)	YES	Ch 3 §Type 1 — Multiple choice
2	Identifying information (True / False / Not Given)	YES	Ch 3 §Type 2 — Identifying information
3	Identifying writer's views/claims (Yes / No / Not Given)	YES	Ch 3 §Type 3 — Identifying writer's views/claims
4	Matching information (to paragraphs)	NO	Ch 3 §Type 4 — Matching information
5	Matching headings	Questions yes; the Roman numerals no	Ch 3 §Type 5 — Matching headings
6	Matching features	NO	Ch 3 §Type 6 — Matching features
7	Matching sentence endings	YES	Ch 3 §Type 7 — Matching sentence endings
8	Sentence completion	YES	Ch 3 §Type 8 — Sentence completion
9	Summary / note / table / flow-chart completion	NOT GUARANTEED — but answers cluster in one region	Ch 3 §Type 9
10	Diagram label completion	NOT GUARANTEED	Ch 3 §Type 10 — Diagram label completion
11	Short-answer questions	YES, usually	Ch 3 §Type 11 — Short-answer questions

The full order table, with the sourcing strength of each row and the two honest caveats, is **Ch 3 §The order table**. Read it before you decide where to start searching — on an ordered type you resume from the last answer; on an unordered one you find the region and work locally.

Cross-cutting Reading references:

You need	Go to
The FALSE / NOT GIVEN decision procedure, and the qualifier trap the right way round	Ch 3 §The FALSE / NOT GIVEN decision procedure
Where the line between reading and inferring sits	Ch 3 §Reading vs inferring — the line
Timing: 19 / 19 / 19 plus the three-minute sweep	Ch 3 §Timing
The mark arithmetic — 27 to 30 is the whole gap	Ch 3 §Band descriptor decoder
Copy-paste, and why completion answers are transcription not composition	Ch 3 §Tips & tricks

B.3 — Writing Task 1: the nine visual types

20 minutes · at least 150 words · a third of the Writing band. The instruction never changes: **summarise, select, compare**.

#	Visual type	Taught in
1	Line graph	Ch 4 §1. Line graph
2	Bar chart	Ch 4 §2. Bar chart
3	Pie chart	Ch 4 §3. Pie chart
4	Table	Ch 4 §4. Table
5	Process diagram — man-made	Ch 4 §5. Process diagram — man-made
6	Process diagram — natural (cycle / life cycle)	Ch 4 §6. Process diagram — natural
7	Map comparison	Ch 4 §7. Map comparison
8	Mixed / multiple charts	Ch 4 §8. Mixed / multiple charts
9	Static diagram — an object, a device, or an event	Ch 4 §9. Static diagram

The nine-way split is a teaching convention, not an official taxonomy. The official list of inputs is *"a diagram, graph, table, chart, map or other visual input"*, and the format page adds *"a diagram of an object, device, process or event"* — which is why **object** and **device** are separate from **process**, and why there are nine sections and not eight. [src: ielts.org — Writing key assessment criteria PDF, p.2; ielts.org — IELTS Academic

format: Writing]

"Or other visual input" is an open category by construction. If you meet something that fits none of the nine, do not reach for a template. Ask two questions, in order:

1. **Is there a time axis?** Yes → trend task: trend verbs legal, tense set by the dates, group by trend behaviour. No → trend verbs are **banned**; your organising principle is comparison (§2, §4, §9).
2. **Is there a sequence?** Yes → process: stages, sequencers, present simple passive, group into phases (§5, §6). Neither → §9.

Cross-cutting Task 1 references:

You need	Go to
Which tense for which visual	Ch 4 §Tense by visual type
Trend verbs, degree and speed adverbs, and the four grammar points that decide marks	Ch 4 §The trend toolkit
Proportion vs figure vs rate vs amount vs trend vs period	Ch 4 §Six word families you must keep apart
What "categorised" means in the band-7 descriptor	Ch 4 §Band descriptor decoder → Task Achievement
The 20-minute budget and the 17-minute stop	Ch 9 §The numbers, in one table

B.4 — Writing Task 2: the five question families

40 minutes · at least 250 words · two thirds of the Writing band · about **17% of your entire IELTS result**.

⚠ These families are a recognition heuristic, not an official taxonomy. IELTS publishes none — not on the format pages, not in the sample tasks PDF, not in the key assessment criteria, not in the descriptors. The two official owners' teaching pages both publish lists and they do not match: the British Council teaches five categories, IDP six [src: takeielts.britishcouncil.org — How to write an English essay for IELTS; ielts.idp.com — How to understand Task 2 writing questions]. The families are reliable shapes and they save planning time. The rule that earns the marks is the official one: **count the instructions in the prompt and answer every one**. Memorise five templates, meet a hybrid prompt, and you will misfire.

#	Family	Recognise it by the final line	Demands	Taught in
1	Opinion (agree / disagree)	<i>To what extent do you agree or disagree?</i>	1	Ch 5 §Family 1 – Opinion
2	Discussion (both views + your own opinion)	<i>Discuss both views and give your own opinion.</i>	3	Ch 5 §Family 2 – Discussion
3	Problem, cause and solution	<i>What are the causes? What can be done?</i>	2	Ch 5 §Family 3 – Problem, cause and solution
4	Advantages and disadvantages	<i>Do the advantages outweigh the disadvantages?</i>	2	Ch 5 §Family 4 – Advantages and disadvantages
5	Two-part / direct question	Two questions of different shapes	2	Ch 5 §Family 5 – Two-part / direct question

The 30-second triage: the family is decided by the *final instruction line* – not the topic, not the statement. Find the last sentence containing a question mark or an imperative and count the separate demands. That count is the number of things your essay must visibly deliver. Two families at once means a hybrid: **obey the demand count, not the family name**. Full triage table: **Ch 5 §Question types, one by one**.

Cross-cutting Task 2 references:

You need	Go to
The four-move body paragraph: claim → because → so what → instance	Ch 5 §Tips & tricks , tip 4
Length – the floor, and why there is no ceiling	Ch 5 §Length: a floor, and no ceiling
Why copying the prompt costs you twice	Ch 5 §Copied rubric: the most expensive shortcut in the test
Hedging, and why it is a band-7 lexical feature	Ch 7 §5. Hedging and stance
The 40-minute budget and the 37-minute stop	Ch 9 §The numbers, in one table

B.5 – Speaking: the three parts

11–14 minutes · live examiner · recorded · four equally weighted criteria · rated on your **average across all parts**.

Part	Shape	Length	Taught in
1	Introduction and interview – familiar topics, short questions	4–5 min	Ch 6 §Part 1 – Introduction and interview
2	The long turn – a cue card, 1 minute to prepare, 1–2 minutes to speak, plus one or two short rounding-off questions	3–4 min including preparation	Ch 6 §Part 2 – The long turn
3	The two-way discussion – abstract questions related to the Part 2 topic, with examiner pushback	4–5 min	Ch 6 §Part 3 – The two-way discussion

Cross-cutting Speaking references:

You need	Go to
Sentence recovery — what to do when you stall mid-sentence	Ch 6 §Tips & tricks , tip 1
The seven drills, each naming what it changes	Ch 6 §Seven drills, each naming what it changes
Rhythm, stress-timing and chunking	Ch 6 §Band descriptor decoder → Pronunciation
The official position on accent	Ch 6 §On accent — the official position, stated plainly
What the grammar transfers cost in <i>speech</i> , as opposed to writing	Ch 6 §The grammar transfers

B.6 — Lexical Resource: the six components

Not a question type, but the same lookup problem: your grade said "Lexical Resource 6" and you need to know which sixth of it broke.

#	Component	Taught in
1	Collocation	Ch 7 §1. Collocation (plus §The ten topic banks)
2	Precision	Ch 7 §2. Precision
3	Register	Ch 7 §3. Register
4	Paraphrase	Ch 7 §4. Paraphrase
5	Hedging and stance	Ch 7 §5. Hedging and stance
6	Spelling and word formation	Ch 7 §6. Spelling and word formation

Only one of the six is range. Spelling and word formation are scored **here**, under Lexical Resource, not under Grammar [src: ielts.org — IELTS Writing key assessment criteria (PDF)].

B.7 — The band-7 grammatical structures

Same lookup problem again, for GRA.

#	Structure	Risk	Taught in
1	The rich noun phrase	near-zero — officially named range indicator	Ch 8 §1. The rich noun phrase
2	Relative clauses	lowest-risk complexity you own	Ch 8 §2. Relative clauses
3	Concession clauses	your highest-frequency trap (<i>although ... but</i>)	Ch 8 §3. Concession clauses
4	Passives	required in Task 1, optional in Task 2	Ch 8 §4. Passives
5	Participle clauses	most under-used cheap signal	Ch 8 §5. Participle clauses
6	The second conditional	one pattern, owned cold	Ch 8 §6. The second conditional
7	Cleft sentences	one per essay, no more	Ch 8 §7. Cleft sentences
8	Nominalisation	register marker, with a tax	Ch 8 §8. Nominalisation

Third conditionals are not on this list on purpose. In the IELTS-published Speaking study, band-7 speakers produced **zero** of them, at every band. Skip them. [src: Roothoof & Breeze 2019, IELTS

Research Reports 2019/1 — Speaking data, L1 mix unreported]